"I'll never be normal."

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Where it often comes from

Comparison with peers and social ideas of normal produce shame, especially for those with ongoing conditions. Longing to be "normal" can turn into grief or anger.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made." God told Samuel, "Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart." Paul writes, "God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong" (1 Corinthians 1:27). Many of God's servants in Scripture were far from ordinary. God does not call us to a statistical average. He calls us to be His beloved children. A good life is still possible.

> *"But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong"* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Also see

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'" (1 Samuel 16:7).

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me" (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

Common self-statements

- Everyone else is normal.
- I will always be different.
- I do not fit.
- Normal people have it easy.
- I will never be like them.
- I cannot live a regular life.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people are either normal or not.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am abnormal.
- Labeling: Calling myself abnormal.

Challenging questions

- What does "normal" mean to me, and where did I get that idea?

- Who do I know that is truly “normal”?
- What has my difference taught me?
- What does Scripture say about God choosing the weak and unusual?
- What parts of a good life are available to me?
- Who accepts me as I am?

Truth summary

> God does not measure me against a statistical average. He made me and loves me, and a good life is possible. My differences can be places where His grace shows.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weakness
- God, Creator
- Worldly
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God’s loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ’s final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus’ love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll never be normal"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never be normal." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "normal" mean to me, and where did I get that idea?
- ☐ Who do I know that is truly "normal"?
- ☐ What has my difference taught me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God choosing the weak and unusual?
- ☐ What parts of a good life are available to me?
- ☐ Who accepts me as I am?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God chose the weak things of the world.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ Normal is not the goal.
- ☐ A good life is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **1 Corinthians 1:27**
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:14**
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **1 Samuel 16:7**
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Accepted as I am: Each week, note one way you were accepted or lived well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God chooses the weak things of the world.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Define a good life. Write what matters to you.
- [ ] Find your people. Join a support group or friends.
- [ ] Celebrate a strength. Name something your experience taught you.
- [ ] Memorize 1 Corinthians 1:27. Say it when you feel different.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never be normal": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Accepted as I am
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never be normal.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I long to be normal. Help me accept how You made me, find a good life, and show Your grace through my story. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.